The Medicaid Application Document Checklist

What to gather, write down and ask while Mom's care goes on.

Mom needs care now, and somewhere on your list it says “Medicaid application.” On the table there's a folder of statements and a stack of mail. Check what you've found. Anything unchecked is something still to look for or to ask about, not a verdict about Mom or about your family.

Gather

- [ ] Papers that show who Mom is and where she lives, such as her Social Security card, a birth certificate and something with her current address on it. [1]
- [ ] Something in writing for each source of her income: Social Security, a pension, anything else that arrives regularly. [2]
- [ ] The bank statements you can find, for every account you know of. [2]
- [ ] Statements for any investment or retirement accounts. [2]
- [ ] Her insurance information: the policies themselves, or a recent statement for each. [2]
- [ ] Papers for any real estate she owns: the deed, a current tax bill, and mortgage or loan papers if there are any. [3]
- [ ] Trust or annuity documents, if she has either.
- [ ] Whatever paperwork you have about money or property that Mom has given or transferred to someone else, if that has happened.
- [ ] If Mom is married, the same kinds of records for her spouse.
- [ ] The paperwork from the place where she is getting care: admission papers, and the recent bills.

Write down

- [ ] Deposits, withdrawals or transfers in the statements that you can't explain, with the date and the amount shown. Note them as you find them and change nothing; going through them is something to do with your Medicaid planner before anything is sent.
- [ ] For each letter from the Medicaid agency, if any has come: the date on it, what it asks for in its own words, and any reply date printed in it, copied as written.

Ask

- [ ] Your Medicaid planner: which Medicaid program and which application fit Mom's situation, and where and how it is submitted where she lives.
- [ ] Your Medicaid planner: when the application should go in, which of these records they would want to see, and what dates the statements should cover.

What this checklist doesn't do

It helps you gather, write down and ask. It doesn't say which records Mom's state asks for, what any statement or letter means, or when to apply. Rules vary by state, and nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice. Those questions go to your Medicaid planner, and to the next step below.

Ready for the next step?

You know which records to start pulling together, and what to ask before anything is sent. The planning interview is the next step: it asks about your family's situation, one question at a time, and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for Mom's care.

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WHERE THIS COMES FROM

Items marked 1, 2 or 3 follow the kinds of records that USA.gov, the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau and the Administration for Community Living say a family may be asked for or should keep together. What a state asks for depends on the state. The rest come from the Medicaid Planning Roadmap's own working list for this step.

1. USA.gov, How to apply for Medicaid and CHIP
2. Consumer Financial Protection Bureau, Planning for diminished capacity and illness
3. Administration for Community Living (LongTermCare.gov), Applying for Medicaid